

Why Most "Fermented" Products Are Not Real Fermentation

The Problem

The market is filled with products labeled as fermented.

Yogurt, kefir, dairy drinks, and similar products are widely presented as fermentation-based.

However, in many cases, fermentation is no longer the defining process.

Instead:

- structure is created artificially
- taste is modified through additives
- consistency is controlled chemically

The result is a product that appears fermented, but is not defined by fermentation.

What Is Missing

There is no clear, system-level definition of what makes a product truly fermented.

Most classifications rely on:

- labeling
- tradition
- marketing
- regulatory approximation

None of these define whether fermentation actually determines the product.

The Core Insight

Fermentation is not a label. It is a process.

A product is not fermented because it is called fermented.

A product is fermented only if biological transformation defines its structure, function, and identity.

What This Standard Establishes

The Lactic Fermented Dairy Products (LFDP™) module defines a simple but strict condition:

Fermentation must be the primary mechanism that creates the

product.

If fermentation is secondary, replaced, or simulated:

The product is no longer a true fermented system.

Why This Matters

Without a clear definition:

- quality becomes subjective
- consumers cannot distinguish real from simulated products
- producers can replace natural processes without transparency

With a clear definition:

- products become measurable
 - classification becomes objective
 - integrity becomes visible
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What Changes

This is not a minor improvement.

It changes how fermented products are understood.

Instead of asking:

"Is this labeled as fermented?"

The correct question becomes:

"Is this product defined by fermentation?"

System Impact

Applying this standard creates a structural shift:

- products defined by additives are separated from true fermentation systems
 - producers must rely on process, not simulation
 - classification becomes based on reality, not perception
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For Producers

This standard provides clarity:

- what qualifies as a true fermented product
 - how to structure production correctly
 - how to differentiate authentically
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For Consumers

This standard removes ambiguity:

- real fermentation becomes identifiable
- product integrity becomes visible
- trust is based on measurable conditions

For the Market

A new category emerges:

products defined by biological transformation, not by labeling.

Closing Statement

Most products claim fermentation.

Very few are defined by it.

LFDP™ does not improve the label.

It defines the reality behind it.

Related Documents

→ [Natural Fermented Beverage Standard \(NFBS™\)](#).

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